
Madiha Afzal



**Fellow, Foreign Policy
Strobe Talbott Center for Security, Strategy, and Technology
Center for Middle East Policy
The Brookings Institution**

Madiha Afzal is a fellow in the Foreign Policy program at Brookings. She was previously the David M. Rubenstein Fellow in the Foreign Policy program. Her work focuses on the U.S.-Pakistan relationship, U.S. policy toward Afghanistan, Pakistan's politics and policy, and extremism in South Asia and beyond. She previously worked as an assistant professor of public policy at the University of Maryland, College Park.

Afzal is the author of "Pakistan Under Siege: Extremism, Society, and the State," published by the Brookings Institution Press in 2018 (the book was also published in South Asia and Afghanistan by Penguin India). Afzal has also published several journal articles, book chapters, policy reports, and essays. In addition, she writes for publications including Foreign Affairs, Foreign Policy, the Washington Post, Dawn, and Newsweek. She is regularly interviewed by media outlets including BBC, NPR, and PBS. In addition, she has consulted for international organizations including the World Bank and UK's Department for International Development. For her writing on education in Pakistan, she was named to Lo Spazio della Politica's list of "Top 100 Global Thinkers of 2013."

Afzal received her doctorate in economics from Yale University in 2008, specializing in development economics and political economy.

Vanda Felbab-Brown



Director – Initiative on Nonstate Armed Actors, Co-Director – Africa Security Initiative, Senior Fellow – Foreign Policy, Strobe Talbott Center for Security, Strategy, and Technology, The Brookings Institution

Vanda Felbab-Brown is a senior fellow in the Strobe Talbott Center for Security, Strategy, and Technology in the Foreign Policy program at Brookings. She is the director of the Initiative on Nonstate Armed Actors. She is also the co-director of the Africa Security Initiative and the Brookings series on opioids: “The Opioid Crisis in America: Domestic and International Dimensions. Previously, she was the co-director of the Brookings project, “Improving Global Drug Policy: Comparative Perspectives Beyond UNGASS 2016,” as well as of another Brookings project, “Reconstituting Local Orders.” Felbab-Brown is an expert on international and internal conflicts and nontraditional security threats, including insurgency, organized crime, urban violence, and illicit economies. Her fieldwork and research have covered, among others, Afghanistan, South Asia, Burma, Indonesia, the Andean region, Mexico, Morocco, Somalia, Kenya, Ethiopia, Djibouti, Tanzania, Namibia, Niger, and Nigeria. She was a senior advisor to the congressionally-mandated Afghanistan Peace Process Study Group.

Felbab-Brown is the author of “The Extinction Market: Wildlife Trafficking and How to Counter It” (Hurst, 2018); “Narco Noir: Mexico’s Cartels, Cops, and Corruption” (The Brookings Institution Press, 2021, forthcoming); “Militants, Criminals, and Warlords: The Challenge of Local Governance in an Age of Disorder” (The Brookings Institution Press, 2018; co-authored with Shadi Hamid and Harold Trinkunas); “Aspiration and Ambivalence: Strategies and Realities of Counterinsurgency and State-Building in Afghanistan” (Brookings Institution Press, 2013); and “Shooting Up: Counterinsurgency and the War on Drugs” (Brookings Institution Press, 2010). She is also the author of numerous policy reports, academic articles, and opinion pieces. A frequent commentator in U.S. and international media, Felbab-Brown regularly provides congressional testimony on these issues and serves as an expert witness in court cases related to transnational crime and governance. She has also been the recipient of numerous awards in recognition of her scholarly and policy contributions.

Felbab-Brown received her doctorate in political science from MIT and her bachelor’s in government from Harvard University.

Amy J. Nelson



***Visiting Fellow, Future Security Program
New America***

Amy J. Nelson works on generating future-forward policy analysis using tools and techniques of prediction and planning with a particular focus on nuclear and artificial intelligence futures. She has a large body of work on arms control and nonproliferation for weapons of mass destruction (WMD), conventional weapons, and emerging technologies.

Before joining New America, she was a David M. Rubenstein Fellow with the Foreign Policy Program at the Brookings Institution, where she completed her forthcoming book, *The Arms Control Paradox: Managing Uncertainty in an Insecure World*. She was previously a Bosch Fellow in residence at the German Council on Foreign Relations, a Fellow at the Center for the Study of WMD at the National Defense University, a Stanton Nuclear Security Fellow at the Council on Foreign Relations, and a policy analyst at the U.S. Department of States Directorate of Defense Trade Controls.

Nelson holds an M.A. and Ph.D. in political science from the University of California, Berkeley, an M.A. in intellectual history from Columbia University, and an A.B. in philosophy with honors from Stanford University.

Natan Sachs



Director, Center for Middle East Policy
Senior Fellow, Foreign Policy, Center for Middle East Policy
The Brookings Institution

Natan Sachs is the director of the Center for Middle East Policy and a senior fellow in the Foreign Policy Program at Brookings.

He has taught as an adjunct professor at Georgetown University's Department of Government and its Security Studies Program. Prior to joining Brookings, Sachs was a Fulbright fellow in Indonesia, a visiting fellow at Tel Aviv University's Dayan Center for Middle East and African Studies, and a Hewlett fellow at Stanford's Center on Democracy, Development, and the Rule of Law.

Sachs is an expert on Israeli foreign policy, its domestic politics, and on U.S. policy toward the Middle East. His writing has appeared in such publications as Foreign Affairs, The Washington Post, The Atlantic, Foreign Policy, The New York Times Global, Yediot Ahronot, and Haaretz. His forthcoming book describes the aftermath of the Israeli-Palestinian peace process, the dangers of both a one-state agenda and "anti-solutionism," and recommends policy for promoting a more peaceful and just relationship among Israelis and Palestinians.

Sachs has provided testimony before Congress and has offered expert commentary to the New York Times, The Washington Post, The Financial Times, The Wall Street Journal, The New Yorker, Bloomberg, and many other publications. He has appeared on TV and radio with CNN, MSNBC, Fox News, the BBC, Bloomberg, Israel Channel 12, Haaretz, and Galei Tzahal, among others.

Sachs is a graduate of the Amirim Excellence program at the Hebrew University in Jerusalem. He received his master's and doctorate in political science from Stanford University.

Landry Signé



**Senior Fellow, Global Economy and Development
Africa Growth Initiative
The Brookings Institution**

Landry Signé is a senior fellow in the Global Economy and Development Program and the Africa Growth Initiative at the Brookings Institution. He was previously a David M. Rubenstein Fellow at Brookings. His career and research span the areas of global political economy, global governance and sustainable development, global business and emerging markets, strategic management and leadership, fragility, state capacity and policy implementation, the Fourth Industrial Revolution and Globalization 4.0, and the political economy of Africa and developing countries.

He is a professor and founding co-director of the Globalization 4.0 and Fourth Industrial Revolution Initiative at the Thunderbird School of Global Management, distinguished fellow at Stanford University's Center for African Studies, chairman of the Global Network for Africa's Prosperity, and senior adviser to top global leaders (presidential, prime minister, and C-suite levels) in business, policy, and international affairs. In addition, he has been on numerous boards and councils including for the World Economic Forum, the United Nations, Ampion Entrepreneurship and Innovation in Africa, and the African Union, was a co-chair of the World Economic Forum YGL Board Governance Initiative (improving board governance in leading public and private corporations, and nonprofit organizations), professor and former senior adviser to the chancellor and provost on international affairs at UAA, among others.

Signé was also a visiting scholar or has taught at the universities of Oxford, Stanford, Georgetown, Montreal, Ottawa, Witwatersrand, as well as the Sub-Regional Institute of Statistics and Applied Economics in Central Africa, Mohamed VI Polytechnic University and HEC Paris School of Management. He taught an award-winning course at Stanford presenting Africa as a continent of economic opportunities ("Emerging African Markets: Strategies, Investments and Government Affairs"), winning the African Network Outstanding Visionary Leadership Award and the Stanford University's Center for African Studies Distinguished Leadership Award "in recognition and honor of distinguished contributions to African studies, innovative teaching, outstanding mentorship, and exceptional service to the community."

Signé was selected as a World Economic Forum Young Global Leader for “finding innovative solutions to some of the world’s most pressing issues,” an Andrew Carnegie Fellow for being one of the “most creative thinkers,” a Desmond Tutu Fellow for driving “the transformation of Africa,” a Woodrow Wilson Public Policy Fellow for “preeminent scholarship uniting the world of ideas to the world of policy,” one of JCI’s Ten Outstanding Young Persons in the World for “extraordinary achievements and dedication exemplifying the best attributes and leadership in academia,” and has won numerous academic awards, including the American Political Science Association Campus Teaching Award, the Chancellor’s Award for Excellence in Teaching, and the Chancellor’s Award for Excellence in Academic Research and Creative Activity.

He is the author of numerous scholarly publications, including books with leading academic presses such as Cambridge University Press (CUP), namely “Innovating Development Strategies in Africa: The Role of International, Regional and National Actors” (CUP 2017), “African Development, African Transformation: How Institutions Shape Development Strategy,” (CUP 2018), “Unlocking Africa’s Business Potential: Trends, Opportunities, Risks, and Strategies” (2020 with the Brookings Institution Press), and “Africa’s Role in the Fourth Industrial Revolution: Ridding the World’s Biggest Disruptive Innovation” (forthcoming). He is also the author or co-author of numerous Brookings reports such as “Spotlighting Opportunities for Business in Africa and Strategies to Succeed in the World’s Next Big Growth Market,” “The Fourth Industrial Revolution and Digitization will Transform Africa into a Global Powerhouse,” “Leaving No Fragile State and No One Behind in a Prosperous World: A New Approach,” “The Potential of Manufacturing and Industrialization in Africa,” “Africa’s Tourism Potential,” “Africa’s Consumer Market Potential,” “Keys to success for the AfCFTA Negotiations,” “Illicit Financial Flows in Africa: Drivers, Destinations, and Policy Options,” “Why has Africa’s Fast Economic Growth Left More Poor People Behind and How Do We Fix it?,” “Accountable Leadership: The Key to Africa’s Successful Transformation,” among others. His work has also appeared in the New York Times, the Washington Post, Foreign Affairs, Foreign Policy, CNBC, Forbes, the Hill, and Harvard International Review, among others.

Signé was educated in Cameroon (with honors and distinction; Vogt College), in France (valedictorian and salutatorian; University of Lyon 3, Sciences Po Paris, Sandar Institute), in Canada (received a series of awards and fellowships for the best doctoral performance; McGill University, and University of Montreal), earned his Ph.D. from the University of Montreal (awarded the Best International Ph.D. Dissertation), and completed his postdoctoral studies at Stanford University (Banting fellowship for best and brightest researchers internationally). He has also completed executive business and leadership programs at the University of Oxford Saïd School of Business and Harvard Kennedy School.

Melanie W. Sisson



**Senior Fellow, Foreign Policy
Center for Security, Strategy, and Technology
The Brookings Institution**

Melanie W. Sisson is a senior fellow in the Foreign Policy program's Strobe Talbott Center for Security, Strategy, and Technology where she researches the use of the armed forces in international politics, strategies of deterrence, U.S. national security strategy, defense policy, and defense applications of emerging technologies. Sisson's current work focuses on U.S. Department of Defense integration of artificial intelligence (AI) and machine learning capabilities into warfighting and enterprise operations. She also serves on the advisory council of the North Rhine-Westphalian Academy for International Affairs based in Bonn, Germany, and as a consultant to STR, a national security AI firm based in Boston.

Sisson previously was vice president of analysis at Govini, an early-stage national security AI/ML technology company, and senior fellow and director of the Stimson Center Defense Strategy and Planning program. At Stimson, Sisson partnered with the Stanley Center and U.N. Office of Disarmament Affairs to address the implications for international security of military applications of AI, and published "Military Coercion and US Foreign Policy: The Use of Force Short of War" (Routledge, 2020). A former senior national security project associate with the RAND Corporation, manager of program evaluation for a non-profit mental health organization, and member of the U.S. intelligence community, Sisson earned a doctorate in political science from the University of Colorado at Boulder, and a master's from the Columbia University School of International Affairs. She is a consultant to the U.S. Department of Defense, lectures regularly with universities nationwide, and is published in national media outlets and academic journals.